

GUIDE 01

ISO Certification Readiness Checklist

Run through this before you engage a consultant or certification body — it'll tell you roughly how far along you already are.

Leadership & Commitment

- ☐ Top management understands its role in the certification process
- ☐ A management representative ("champion") has been assigned
- ☐ Certification objectives and a realistic timeline are agreed and documented

People & Training

- ☐ Staff are aware of the requirements relevant to their role
- ☐ Roles and responsibilities are clearly defined and assigned

Internal Audit & Review

- ☐ At least one internal audit has been completed against the standard
- ☐ Nonconformances from the internal audit have corrective actions assigned
- ☐ A management review meeting has been held and minuted

Documentation

- ☐ A policy statement exists and is communicated to staff
- ☐ Core business processes are mapped and documented
- ☐ Required procedures are drafted (document control, nonconformance, corrective action)

Operational Readiness

- ☐ Risk assessments have been completed for key processes
- ☐ Legal and regulatory requirements have been identified
- ☐ Records are being kept that show the system is actually in use

Certification Audit Prep

- ☐ Stage 1 (documentation review) gaps have been closed
- ☐ Staff know what to expect and how to answer auditor questions
- ☐ A mock or pre-audit has been considered